

EASTERN MEDITERRANEAN UNIVERSITY Department of Political Science and International Relations

Course: PSIR 307 – Political Philosophy (Fall 2024) **Instructor:** Prof. Dr. Erol Kaymak
Credits: 3 (6 ECTS)

Course Description: This course provides a comprehensive overview of the history of political thought. By examining classical and modern texts, students will explore foundational concepts such as justice, authority, liberty, equality, and the social contract. The course focuses on how historical thinkers have shaped contemporary political institutions and ideologies.

Required Text: *Selected readings from the Political Philosophy Reader (provided via course portal).*

Grading Policy:

- Midterm Exam: 30%
- Final Exam: 40%
- Assignments (Ödev): 15%
- Attendance & Participation (Katılım): 15%

Weekly Schedule:

- Week 1: Introduction to Political Philosophy
- Week 2: Plato – The Republic and the Concept of Justice
- Week 3: Aristotle – Politics and the Good Life
- Week 4: Machiavelli – The Prince and Realpolitik
- Week 5: Thomas Hobbes – Leviathan and the State of Nature
- Week 6: John Locke – Second Treatise and Property Rights
- Week 7: **Midterm Examination**
- Week 8: Jean-Jacques Rousseau – The Social Contract
- Week 9: Immanuel Kant – Morality and the State
- Week 10: J.S. Mill – On Liberty and Utilitarianism
- Week 11: Karl Marx & Friedrich Engels – The Communist Manifesto
- Week 12: John Rawls – A Theory of Justice
- Week 13: Contemporary Debates in Political Philosophy
- Week 14: Course Review & Final Exam Preparation